

# Project Overview

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## Problem Statement

### 1.1 Background

Animal shelters across the country operate in fragmented, often manual environments. Individual shelters manage their own intake, adoption workflows, and medical records in isolation with little to no interoperability between branches of the same organization. This disconnection results in animals being overlooked, applications getting lost, and adopters receiving inconsistent experiences depending on which shelter they interact with.

Meanwhile, prospective adopters struggle to discover animals across multiple shelter locations, track the status of their applications, and coordinate appointments all of which creates friction that directly reduces adoption rates.

### 1.2 The Problem

There is no unified, multi-shelter platform that:

- Connects adopters with animals across all shelter branches of an organization in one place.
- Enables shelter staff to manage animal profiles, transfer animals between shelters, and coordinate care workflows collaboratively.
- Maintains a universal health passport for each animal that travels with the animal across shelter transfers.
- Gives veterinary staff a dedicated interface to manage appointments and vaccination records.
- Provides administrators with organization-wide oversight - capacity management, staff, and analytics - from a single control panel.

The absence of such a system leads to duplicated effort, data inconsistencies, delayed adoptions, and a poor experience for all stakeholders.

### 1.3 Goals & Objectives

The Animal Adoption Management System aims to:

- Build a centralized, multi-shelter network platform that unifies animal listings, adoption workflows, and medical records across all branches of an organization.
- Enable seamless inter-shelter animal transfers with automatic capacity checks and a health passport that persists across relocations.
- Provide role-specific interfaces and permissions for four distinct user types: Admins, Shelter Staff, Adopters, and Veterinarians.
- Deliver an AI-powered pet-adopter compatibility matcher to improve adoption success rates and reduce returns.
- Support donation management, volunteer coordination, and event organization to strengthen community engagement.
- Lay the foundation for future features such as automated care reminders and predictive analytics on adoption trends.